capital account liberalization as a formally declared goal of the institution. Just prior to and during the 2007–2009 global financial crisis, former Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor V. K. Reddy gave a series of speeches at high-profile forums, including the World Economic Forum (WEF) at Davos, Switzerland, promoting the idea that new regional financial institutions should exist alongside the Bretton Woods institutions in order to provide "diversity," and advocating the reregulation of India's (and other developing countries') national financial sectors to expand local policy space, while partially rolling back financial globalization.[198] Governor Reddy also served on the UN General Assembly (UNGA) panel on revamping the global financial architecture known as the Stiglitz Commission (see Chapter 3).

In 2009, Eswar Prasad, an Indian-born U.S. professor and former IMF economist, wrote, "There are times when a country has the calling to step forward on the world stage and transform its role from that of a passive follower to that of a leader… . India's response to the crisis has been far more mature than that of many developed economies, without reflexive moves towards financial protectionism or a reversal of initiatives towards financial market development. This gives India credibility . . . "[199] Beginning in 2011, senior Indian economic policymakers explicitly promoted the idea of a "BRICS development bank" among their BRICS colleagues, and Prime Minister Singh formally proposed the idea at the New Delhi BRICS summit in 2012.

India has also used its membership in the G20, as well as in the Financial Stability Board (FSB) in Basel, to promote other shifts embodying its preferences. For example, India is the world's largest recipient of migrants' remittances, receiving about $70 billion annually. At the November 2014 G20 Summit in Brisbane, Australia, India pushed for, and received, an agreement in principle for the developed economies and/or wealthy Middle Eastern countries where most of these remittances originate to cut the costs of these transfers, which have averaged over 5 percent of the value transferred.[200] India's vocal private business sector also promotes Indian activism in global financial governance, and several recent expert commissions constituted by India's Union (federal) government have pushed this agenda.

In 2007, the Singh government created the Percy Mistry Committee, named for the prominent financier who chaired it, to study options for